



SERVICE RELIABILITY MONITORING & ANALYSIS

This project analyzes the Chicago Transit Authority's (CTA) bus and train service reliability using live and historical alert data. It provides a real time view of current service status across all routes, along with a persistence analysis that flags routes stuck in an unchanged status for extended periods. An 8 day historical view is included to uncover patterns in delays, disruptions, and affected routes over time broken down separately for bus and train service to highlight routes and time of day trends. The project concludes with a set of data driven recommendations, connecting these findings to CTA's own stated goals and financial constraints as outlined in its FY2026 Budget Book.

Content

- 1 Status (Live)
- 2 Persistence (Live)
- 3 Overview (Historical)
- 4 Performance (Historical)
- 5 Recommendations & Insights
- 6 ERD
- 7 Project Workflow
- 8 Analytical Workflow
- 9 Data Dictionary

About

- 1 Tools: SQL Server | Power BI | SQL Server Agent | Jira | Python | VS Code
- 2 Last Updated: Sept 2026
- 3 Designed by: Ayesha Batool



Delay Rate

0.0%

Share of tracked services currently reporting a delay

Services Tracked

138

Disrupted Services

55

Normal Services

83

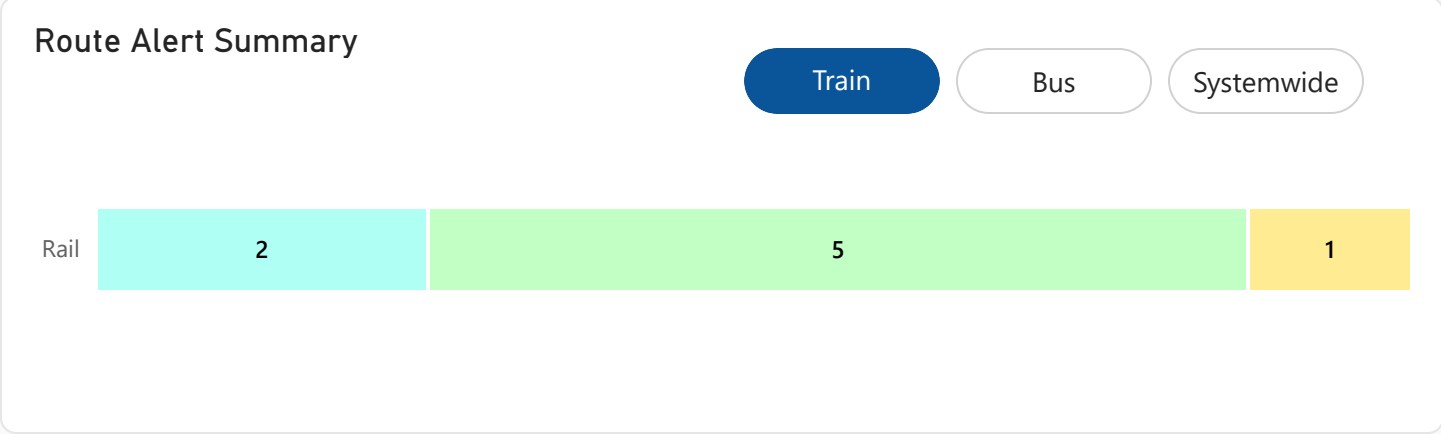
Tracking 138 routes (127 Bus · 8 Rail · 3 Systemwide)

Train Lines Alert Summary

Route	Severity Level	Current Status
Blue Line	Medium	Service Change
Brown Line	No Delay	Normal Service
Green Line	No Delay	Normal Service
Orange Line	No Delay	Normal Service
Pink Line	No Delay	Normal Service
Red Line	No Delay	Normal Service
Purple Line	Low	Added Service
Yellow Line	Low	Added Service

Systemwide Alert Summary

Route	Severity Level	Current Status
All Bus Routes	Medium	Service Change
All Routes	No Delay	Normal Service
All Train Routes	No Delay	Normal Service



Bus Lines Alert Summary

Route	Severity Level	Current Status
Montrose	Medium	Service Change
67th-69th-71st	Medium	Planned Reroute
Archer	Medium	Planned Reroute
Armitage	Medium	Planned Reroute
Austin	Medium	Planned Reroute
Blue Island/26th	Medium	Planned Reroute
Broadway	Medium	Planned Reroute
California/Dodge	Medium	Planned Reroute
Chicago	Medium	Planned Reroute
Clarendon/Michigan Express	Medium	Planned Reroute
Cottage Grove	Medium	Planned Reroute
Damen	Medium	Planned Reroute
Division	Medium	Planned Reroute
Foster	Medium	Planned Reroute
Halsted	Medium	Planned Reroute
Harrison	Medium	Planned Reroute
Hyde Park Express	Medium	Planned Reroute
Inner Lake Shore/Michigan Express	Medium	Planned Reroute
Jackson Park Express	Medium	Planned Reroute
Jeffery Jump	Medium	Planned Reroute
Jeffery Local	Medium	Planned Reroute
Kimball-Homan	Medium	Planned Reroute
Lunt	Medium	Planned Reroute

- Major Delays
- Minor Delays
- Minor Delays/Reroute
- Service Change
- Planned Reroute
- Planned Work
- Added Service
- Bus Stop Relocation
- Special Note
- Bus Stop Note
- Normal Service

Disrupted Services

55

Persistent Bus Alerts

51

Out of 127

Persistent Rail Alerts

3

Out of 8

Persistent Systemwide Alerts

1

Out of 3

Tracking 138 routes (127 Bus · 8 Rail · 3 Systemwide)

Persistence
Level Chronic
Category



Persistence
Level
Persistent Ca...



Bus Route Alert Summary

ID	Route Name	Interpretation	Persistence Level	Status
78	Montrose	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Service Change
10	Obama Presidential Center/Museum of Science & Industry Express	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
115	Pullman/115th	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
124	Navy Pier	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
125	Water Tower Express	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
146	Inner Lake Shore/Michigan Express	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
148	Clarendon/Michigan Express	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
15	Jeffery Local	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
157	Streeterville/Taylor	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
172	U. of Chicago/Kenwood	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
192	U. of Chicago Hospitals Express	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
2	Hyde Park Express	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
29	State	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
36	Broadway	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
37	Sedgwick	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
4	Cottage Grove	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
49	Western	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
50	Damen	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
6	Jackson Park Express	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
60	Blue Island/26th	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
62	Archer	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
66	Chicago	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute
67	67th-69th-71st	Status unchanged for 1 hr	▼ Chronic	Planned Reroute

Bus

Train & Systemwide

Major Delays

Minor Delays

Minor Delays/Reroute

Service Change

Planned Reroute

Planned Work

Added Service

Bus Stop Relocation

Special Note

Bus Stop Note

Normal Service

System Health
60.7%

System Delay Rate
1.9%

Disruption Rate
39.3%

Disrupted Routes
23.2%

Date

All

Weekday

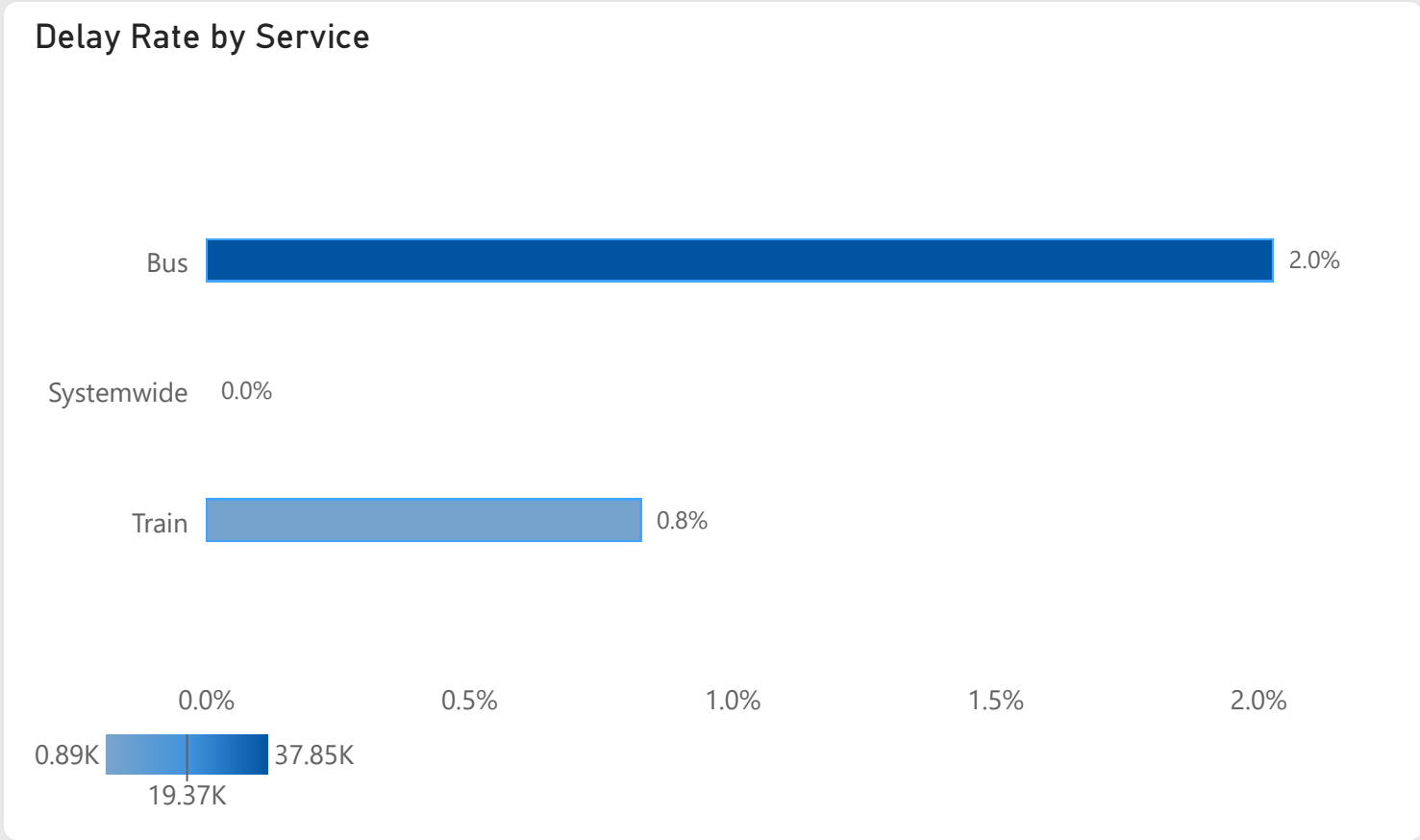
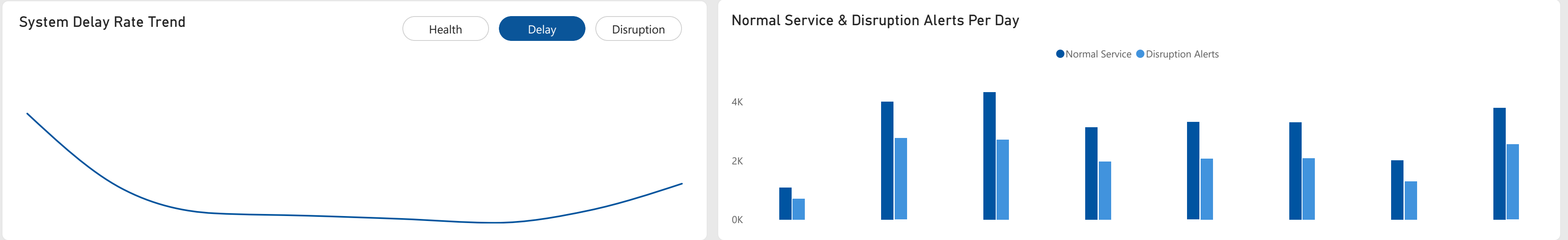
All

Train Route

All

Bus Route

All



Alert Summary by Status Category

Alert Status	Category	Disruption Alerts	%Disruptions
Planned Reroute	Planned Change	10279	25.00%
Added Service	Information	2316	5.63%
Bus Stop Note	Information	1699	4.13%
Service Change	Planned Change	743	1.81%
Bus Stop Relocation	Planned Change	390	0.95%
Minor Delays / Reroute	Delays	298	0.72%
Total	Delays	16158	39.29%

- Delays
- Information
- Planned Change
- Normal Service

Delay Rate

2.0%

Affected Routes

29

Peak Daily Hour

5

Highest Day Period

Afternoon

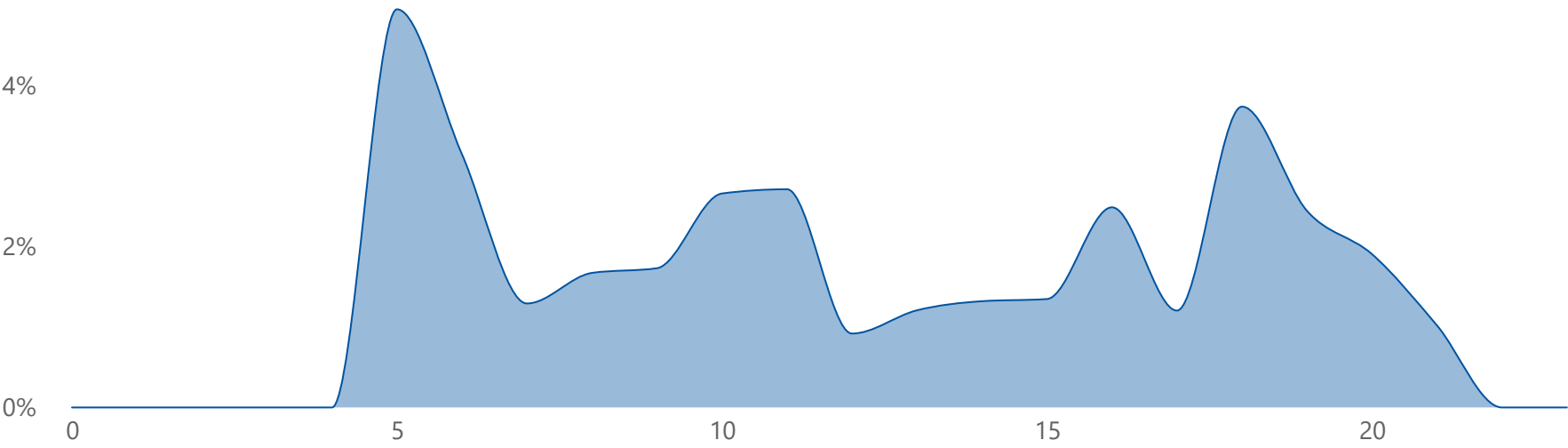
Highest Weekday

Saturday

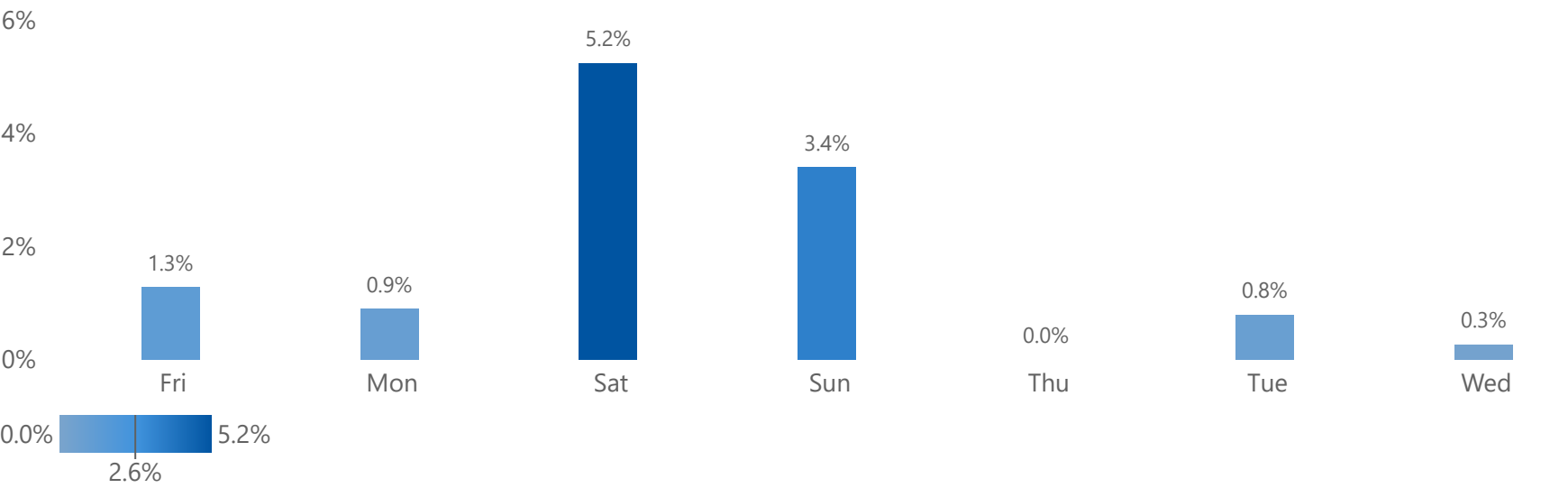
Bus

Train

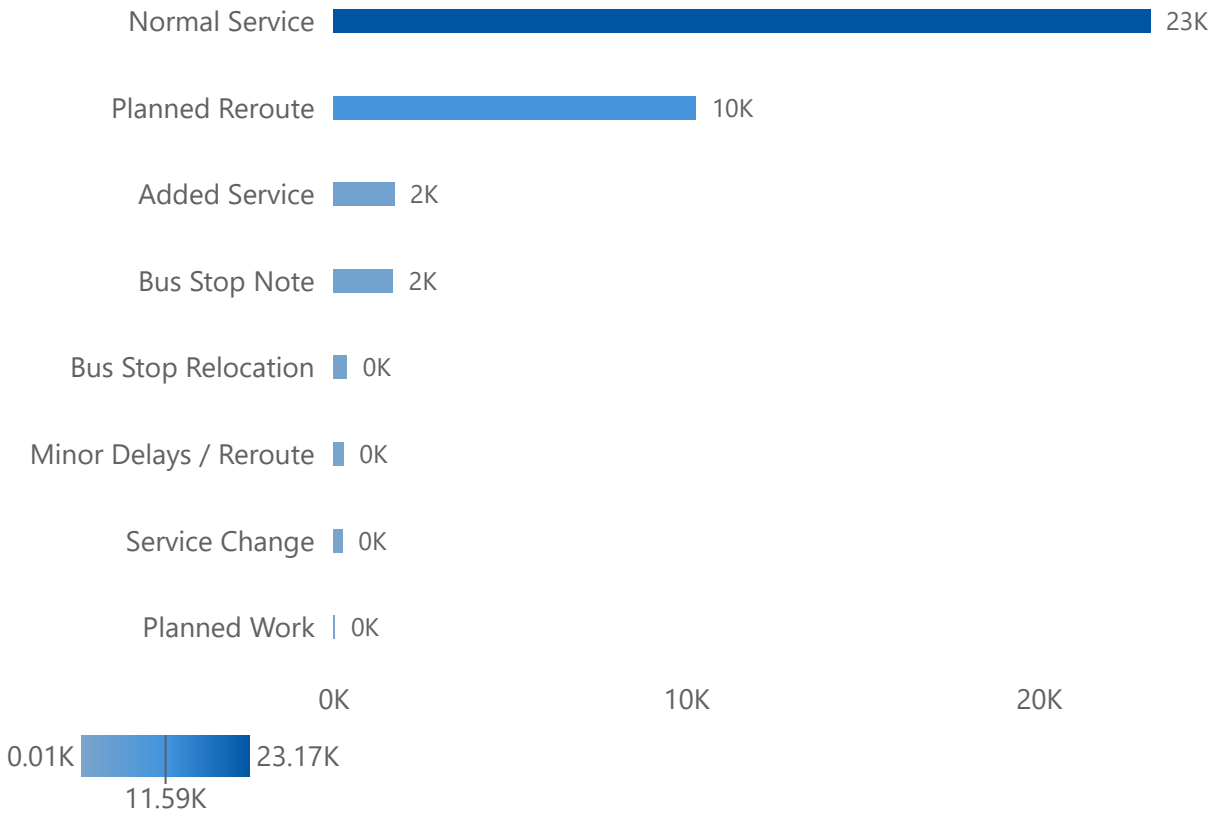
Hourly Delay Rate



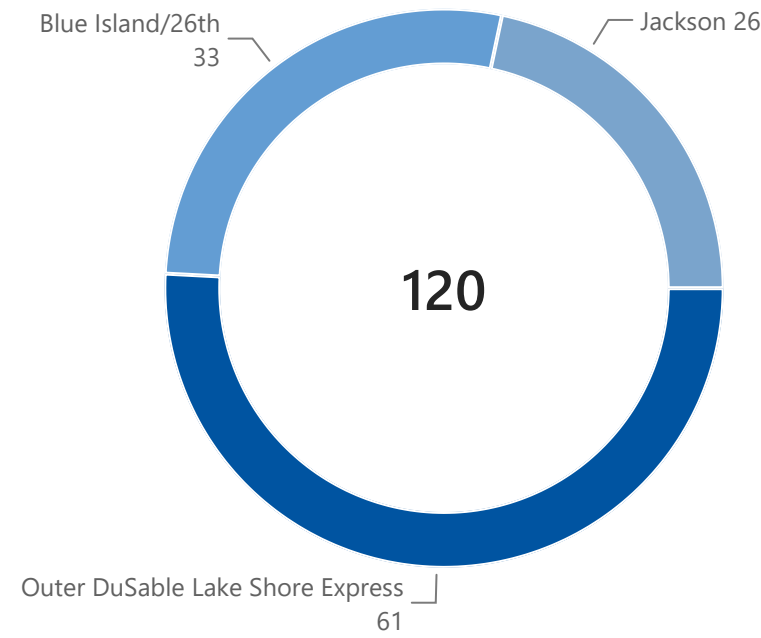
Delay Rate by Weekday



Status Distribution



Bottom 3 Bus Lines by Delays



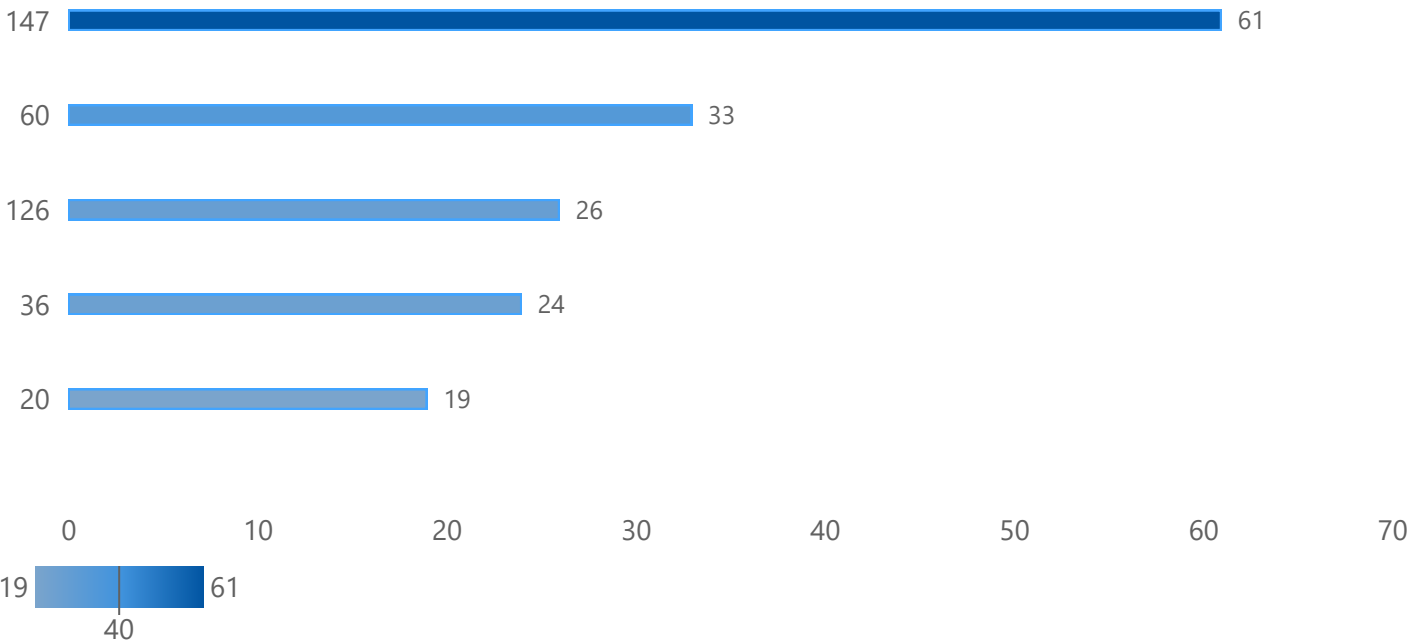
Visual

Detail

Bottom 5

Bottom 10

All



Disruption Rate
39.3%

System Delay Rate
1.9%

Bus Delay Rate
2.0%

Train Delay Rate
0.8%

Disrupted Routes
23.2%

Overall

- CTA's system health is 60.7%
- Disruption rate is 39.3% & delay rate is 1.9%.

- Disruption rates are not delays, they should be tracked and communicated separately depending on their severity level.

- Use clear status categories in rider-facing displays.
- Improve rider understanding of service impact and help operations interpret each status more clearly.

Bus Delay Rate

- Bus delay rate is 2.0%
- Peak delays: 5-6 AM & 6-7 PM
- Highest day period: Afternoon | Highest day: Saturday
- Top 3 routes: Blue Island/26th, Jackson 26, Outer DuSable Shore Express

- Delays are concentrated in specific periods and routes, indicating areas for targeted investigation.

- Investigate traffic, running time, bunching, and operator/fleet availability.
- Prioritize affected routes and periods in CTA's running-time review for targeted improvements.

Train Delay Rate

- Train delay rate is 0.8%.
- Peak delays is 10 AM, 4 PM & 7 PM.
- Highest day period: Afternoon | Highest day: Wednesday
- Top 3 train lines: Blue, Green & Pink

- Delays are concentrated on specific lines and time periods, indicating areas for targeted investigation.

- Investigate slow zones, running time, and other operational factors.
- Compare affected lines and peak periods with CTA's slow-zone elimination work to reduce delays.

Route Statuses

- High disruption-alert volumes on certain routes may indicate recurring service issues.

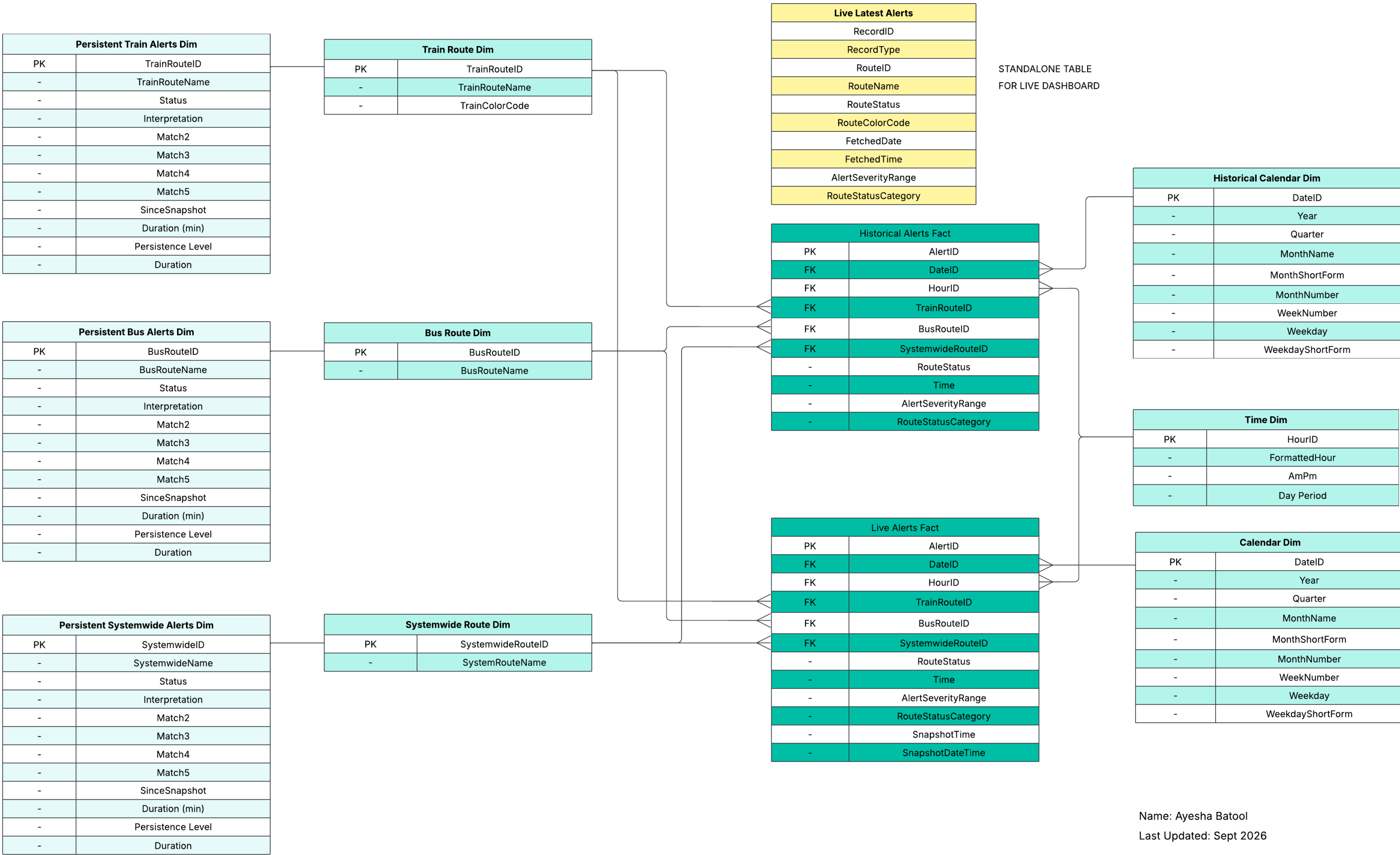
- Recurring alerts may have operational or external causes.

- Prioritize high-alert routes for root-cause analysis.
- Focus on reducing recurring service disruptions, not the number of alerts reported.

ENTITY RELATIONSHIP DIAGRAM (ERD)

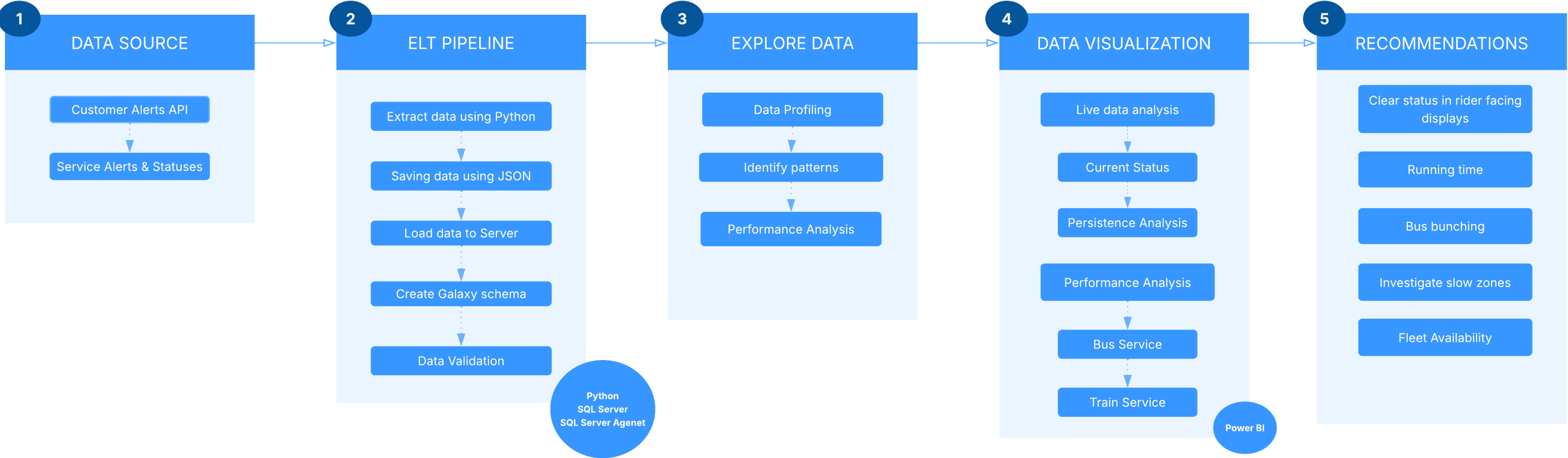
Galaxy Schema

Chicago Transit Authority (CTA) Service Reliability Analysis

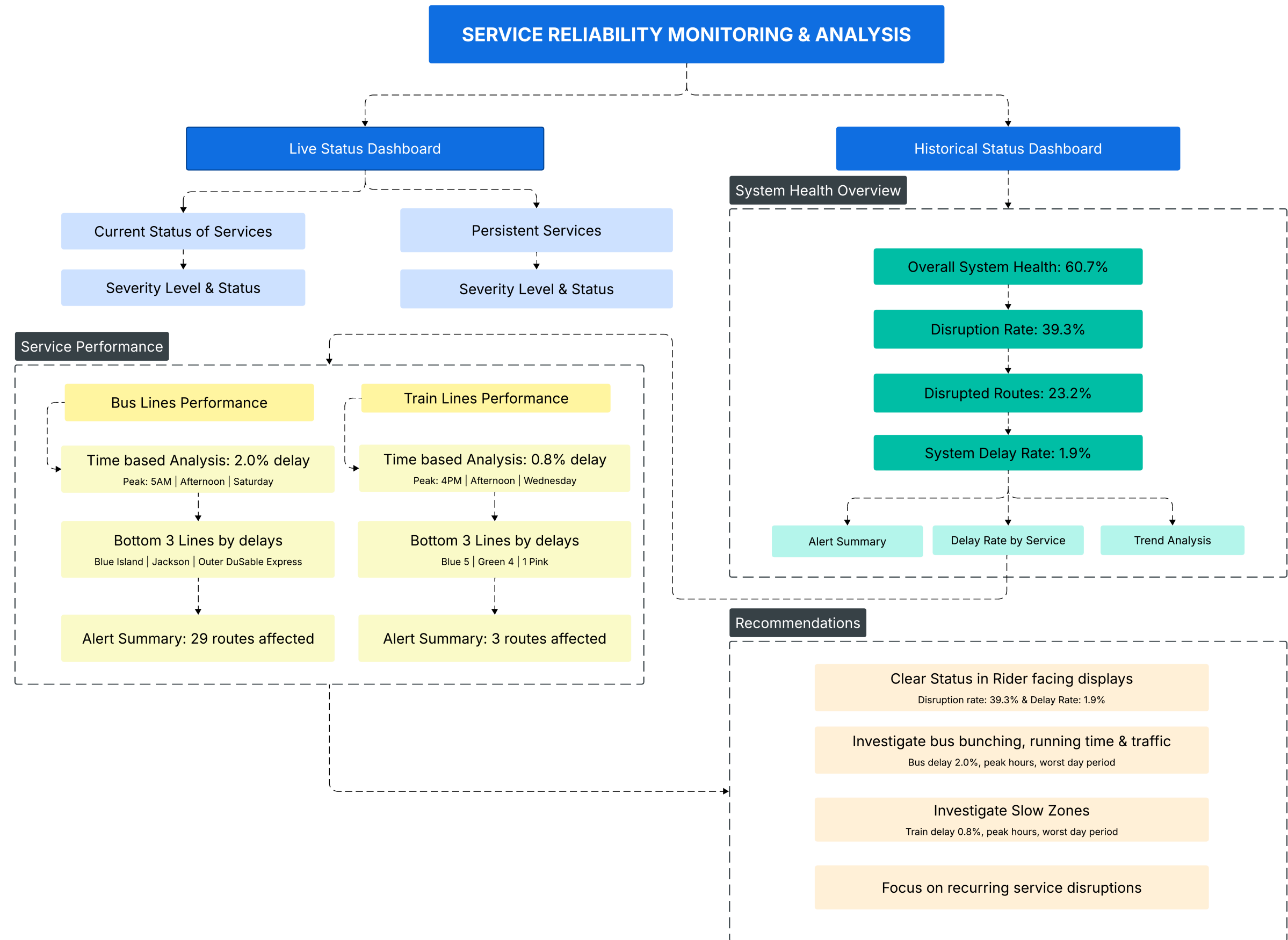


PROJECT WORKFLOW

Chicago Transit Authority (CTA) Performance Analysis



ANALYTICAL WORKFLOW



DATA DICTIONARY

Column Name	Data Type	Description	Key	Table Name
BusRouteID	Text	Unique identifier for each bus route	PK	BusRoute
BusRouteName	Text	Name of the bus route	-	BusRoute
DateID	Date	Unique identified used to link records to the Calendar table	PK	Calendar Dim
MonthName	Text	Full name of the month	-	Calendar Dim
MonthNumber	Whole Number	Numeric representation of the month (1-12)	-	Calendar Dim
MonthShortForm	Text	3 letter abbreviation of the month, used for concise reporting & visualizations	-	Calendar Dim
Quarter	Whole Number	Quarter of the year (Q1-Q4)	-	Calendar Dim
Weekday	Text	Name of the day of the week	-	Calendar Dim
WeekdayShortForm	Text	Abbrevated name of the day of the week, used for concise reporting & visualizations	-	Calendar Dim
WeekNumber	Whole Number	Week number of the year	-	Calendar Dim
Year	Whole Number	Calendar year of the date	-	Calendar Dim
AlertID	Whole Number	Unique identified for each alert record	PK	Historical Alerts Fact
AlertSeverityRange	Text	Severity level associated with the alert eg 0, 1-19, 20-39	-	Historical Alerts Fact
BusRouteID	Text	Links each alert to the BusRoute table	FK	Historical Alerts Fact
DateID	Date	Links each alert to the Calendar table	FK	Historical Alerts Fact
HourID	Whole Number	Links each alert to the Time table	FK	Historical Alerts Fact
RouteStatus	Text	Status of the route at the time of the alert	-	Historical Alerts Fact
RouteStatusCategory	Text	Category grouping assigned to the route status	-	Historical Alerts Fact
SystemwideRouteID	Text	Links each alert to the SystemwideRoute table	FK	Historical Alerts Fact
Time	Time	Timestamp indicating when the alert occurred	-	Historical Alerts Fact
TrainRouteID	Text	Links each alert to the TrainRoute table	FK	Historical Alerts Fact